

GitHub announces Copilot

GitHub has announced Copilot, their new AI Programming suggestion service which can provide suggestions for lines of code or even entire functions inside your code editor. GitHub Copilot is powered by OpenAI's Codex and their AI model has been trained on billions of lines of publicly available code. It is currently available as a Visual Studio Code extension so you can either install it on your local machine or even on GitHub Codespaces, GitHub's cloud-hosted customisable Visual Studio Code environment. Copilot is fast at querying your code as you type so it can provide suggestions as you code and keep up with your typing speed.

As of now, GitHub Copilot can work with a wide array of programming languages and frameworks such as



JavaScript, TypeScript, Ruby, Python and Go. GitHub analyses function names and variables as you type them out and provides suggestions for completing your line of code or even the entire function. If there are multiple alternatives to choose from, you will be able to switch between each suggestion and find the right one for your needs. You can choose whether to accept the suggestion or

reject it. Copilot will alter its suggestions as per your inputs and adapt to your coding style. This also helps developers navigate new programming languages without having to dive into the documentation much.

Copilot has also come under some criticism

as it has been copying code with security flaws and suggesting the same. Also, it has been replicating chunks of code without actually acknowledging the license attached to the code. So some developers have been irked by Copilot flagrantly stealing their published code. It stands to be seen how the company will react to these criticisms before launching the final product.

AAB replaces APK for good

Developers building apps for the Android ecosystem will have to adopt the Android App Bundle (AAB) starting August 2021. AAB was introduced back in May 2018 and allows Google Play store to optimise APKs for distribution on different configurations and makes the overall application smaller by about 15 per cent. It also upgrades your app signing key by switching to a newer cryptographically stronger app signing key. It also allows the ability to customise which feature modules need to be delivered to devices and allows developers to optimise as per install-time or entertain on-



demand requests. This also makes it easier for the Play Store to deliver large asset files which are commonly seen with games with heavy textures. This is currently handled using OBBs which are not signed. These will be replaced with either the Play Asset Delivery or Play

Feature Delivery feature. Existing apps will not be affected by the switch to AAB and this is only applicable to new apps that are going to be published on the Play Store.



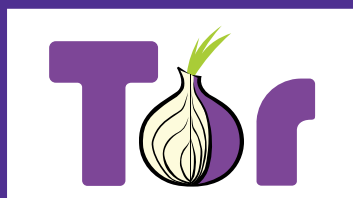
*Windows Terminal Preview 1.10

Microsoft has updated the Windows Terminal Preview to version 1.10 bringing bold text, Quake mode and UI updates.
<https://dgit.in/WinTerm110>



*Ghidra 10 released

The NSA's favourite reverse engineering tool has been upgraded to version 10 bringing with it a massive update with the debugger.
<https://dgit.in/Ghidra10>



*Tor announces Arti

Tor project has announced Arti, a new project to rewrite Tor in Rust to reduce their troubles with C and improve security.
<https://dgit.in/TorArti>